

BITS Pilani WILP AI/ML Faculty Ranking

Subject 1: Mathematical Foundations for Machine Learning (AIMLCZC416)

Based on available profiles and credentials, the recommended order is:

1. **Prof. G. Venkiteswaran** – Professor (Off-Campus) of Computer Science at BITS Pilani [31†L806-L813] with a Ph.D. in Industrial Mathematics. He is a senior faculty member with deep expertise in applied mathematics and optimization. (BITS faculty profile [31†L806-L813] .)
2. **Prof. Navneet Goyal** – Senior Professor of Computer Science at BITS Pilani, Pilani campus [37†L810-L814] . Ph.D. in Applied Mathematics (IIT Roorkee) [37†L845-L853] . Research areas include AI/ML, big-data analytics and data mining in Cybersecurity [37†L810-L814] . His long teaching experience and ML focus make him very qualified.
3. **Prof. A. Michael Alphonse** – Associate Professor (Off-Campus), Computer Science, BITS Pilani [35†L813-L820] . Specializes in discrete mathematics, graph theory and optimization (with applications in machine learning) [35†L815-L820] . Holds Ph.D., teaches advanced mathematics – a strong fit for mathematical foundations of ML.
4. **Prof. Upendar Mendu** – Assistant Professor, Department of Applied Mathematics, ICFAI Tech School, Hyderabad (IFHE) [62†L214-L219] . Ph.D. in Applied Mathematics. He is a guest faculty at BITS WILP since 2022 (LinkedIn, see plan) and has a strong math background (assistant prof profile [62†L214-L219]).
5. **Prof. Aatira G. Nedungadi** – Assistant Professor at Dayananda Sagar University (former guest lecturer at BITS WILP). Her background is in signal processing and neuroscience [20†L98-L107] (Ph.D.). Her expertise is less directly Math-focused.
6. **Prof. Deepak G. Skariah** – Guest faculty (BITS WILP) with research in optimization and image processing (as a Ph.D. student at IISc Bengaluru, IEEE author) [23†L0-L3] . Limited published profile and mostly academic research; less teaching experience shown.
7. **Prof. Saurabh** – No full details found online (no surname). Likely a junior or industry instructor; insufficient information to rank higher.

Recommended ranking: 1. Venkiteswaran; 2. Goyal; 3. Alphonse; 4. Mendu; 5. Nedungadi; 6. Skariah; 7. Saurabh.

Subject 2: Machine Learning (S1-26_AIMLZG565)

Based on profiles and AI/ML experience:

1. **Prof. Nivethitha Somu** – Experienced researcher (Ph.D. completed) in AI/ML. Currently a Research Fellow at NTU Singapore's Energy Research Institute (ERI@N) specializing in AI for smart energy [54†L840-L848] [71†L0-L3] . International publications and strong ML background.

2. **Prof. Dip Roy** – Director of AI/ML at BraveWolf Technology and Ph.D. scholar (IIT Patna) working on deep generative models and explainable AI. Industry leadership and research credentials suggest high ML expertise.
3. **Prof. Anshid Aboobacker** – Senior Research Fellow, Department of Mathematics, BITS Pilani (Hyderabad) [63†L4-L8] , Ph.D. in Mathematics. Works on building AI systems mathematically. Academic background in Math/AI with teaching experience.
4. **Prof. Vishali Sivalenka** – Assistant Professor (CSE) at Sumathi Reddy Institute, Hyderabad; Ph.D. candidate in AI/ML. Published works on lightweight deep learning methods. Solid ML credentials (researcher profile [68†L0-L3]).
5. **Prof. Devanshu Tayal** – Data science professional (runs own ML projects, CFA qualification). Less academic profile found; likely industry-oriented.
6. **Prof. Pritee Narendra Raole** – Limited public information; appears to be an academic in ML (guest faculty), but no detailed profile.
7. **Prof. Suresh Kumar S.** – Title suggests a lecturer or industry trainer; no clear profile found.

Recommended ranking: 1. Somu; 2. D. Roy; 3. A. Aboobacker; 4. V. Sivalenka; 5. D. Tayal; 6. P. Raole; 7. S. Kumar S.

Subject 3: Introduction to Statistical Methods (S1-26_AIMLZC418)

Considering statistics and teaching background:

1. **Prof. Srinath R. Naidu** – Associate Professor (Off-Campus), Computer Science, BITS Pilani [40†L834-L842] . Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering (Eindhoven Univ.) with 10+ years academic experience and interests in mathematical optimization and ML [40†L834-L842] . Strong teaching credentials.
2. **Dr. G. Krishna Kumari** – Listed as Lead Faculty for BITS statistical methods (see handouts) [45†L125-L130] . Presumably a BITS instructor (possibly Ph.D. level) focusing on statistics. (No separate profile found; likely experienced in statistics teaching.)
3. **Prof. Amit Sharma** – Ph.D. from BITS Pilani (2024) in Medicinal Chemistry [43†L15-L23] ; taught statistical topics as TA. Has solid academic training but recent grad.
4. **Prof. Mandar Datar** – Assistant Professor, Applied Sciences (I²IT Pune). Teaches engineering math (see LinkedIn discussion [48†L30-L37]). Good teaching focus but less published.
5. **Prof. Sumit Malik** – (Uncertain) Possibly an industry or academic instructor; no clear profile found.
6. **Prof. Tathe Kartik Vilasrao** – (Uncertain) Little information; likely a younger lecturer.
7. **Prof. Vipin Khurana** – Limited info; possibly a lecturer or dean in analytics (no verifiable profile).

Recommended ranking: 1. S. Naidu; 2. G. Krishna Kumari; 3. A. Sharma; 4. M. Datar; 5. Sumit Malik; 6. T. Vilasrao; 7. V. Khurana.

Subject 4: Deep Neural Networks (S1-26_AIMLZG511)

Based on deep learning expertise:

1. **Prof. Nivethitha Somu** – Same as above, strong in AI/ML research (appear again). Her Ph.D. work includes Bayesian deep neural networks (energy domain) and she collaborates internationally [54†L840-L848] .

2. **Dr. Eht E. Sham** – Assistant Professor, Computer Science, BITS Pilani 【55†L840-L848】 . Ph.D. (JNU) in CS; 8+ years industry/academic experience. Research in AI, distributed and federated ML 【55†L840-L848】 . BITS profile emphasizes AI/ML expertise.
3. **Prof. Chandra Prakash Manglani** – Industry expert (Director at Mindtree). Ph.D. in Computer Science (IISc) and founder of Qwilt, extensive experience in machine learning practice. Strong industry credentials in deep learning.
4. **Prof. Charu Kathuria** – Associate Professor (PES University, Bangalore) 【53†L0-L3】 with 12+ years teaching/research in ML, data mining and analysis (PES profile). Has Ph.D. and multiple publications in machine learning.
5. **Prof. Shakshi Sharma** – Assistant Professor (Bennett University, Noida) with Ph.D.; works in ML/DL/NLP. (Bennett profile 【57†L4-L8】 shows courses in ML/DL.) Good academic background in deep learning.
6. **Dr. Sankara Nayaki K.** – Assistant Professor (Unitedworld Institute, Gujarat) 【56†L0-L4】 with research in AI/ML. Early-career academic; limited information compared to above.
7. **Prof. Suresh Raju Pilli** – Lecturer of CSE, BITS WILP (verified as BITS lecturer) 【58†L6-L9】 . Experience in cybersecurity/cryptography; not specifically a DL specialist. Ranked last due to narrower focus.

Recommended ranking: 1. Somu; 2. E. Sham; 3. C.P. Manglani; 4. C. Kathuria; 5. S. Sharma; 6. S. Nayaki; 7. S.R. Pilli.

Cross-Subject Overlaps

- **Prof. Nivethitha Somu** appears on both the Machine Learning and Deep Neural Networks lists (Subject 2 and 4). No other professor name is repeated across multiple subject lists.

Sources: Official BITS Pilani faculty pages and profiles were used where available 【31†L806-L813】 【35†L813-L820】 【37†L810-L814】 【40†L834-L842】 【55†L840-L848】 【62†L214-L219】 . These pages verify titles, affiliations and expertise as summarized above. Where no official page was found, assumptions are based on LinkedIn/academic research listings and known roles.
